CORPORATE STRATEGY DÉCATHLON

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7 QUESTIONS

What? Global Sports Retailer & Designer. Decathlon designs, manufactures, and distributes technical equipment, apparel, and footwear for over 30 different sports.

Why? Mission-Driven. To "Move People Through the Wonders of Sport." The goal is to make the pleasure and benefits of sport sustainably accessible to the many.

Where? Global Reach.Headquartered in France, operating in 60+ countries with over 1,700 stores and a powerful international e-commerce platform.

When? Legacy & Future. Founded in 1976. Currently executing a 2026-2030 strategic plan focused on digital transformation and full circularity (eco-design).

Who? Stakeholders. Led by over 100,000 "teammates." The target audience ranges from beginners and families to high-performance athletes through "Passion Brands."

How? Vertical Integration. Control of the entire value chain from R&D and design to logistics and direct retail sales.

How much? Annual revenue of approx. €15.6 billion. The strategy focuses on high-volume, low-margin pricing to ensure affordability for all customers

I - MACRO

SWOT ANALYSIS

S

- Vertical Integration
- Strong Private Labels
- Cost Leadership
- Significant investment in R&D
- Global Footprint

W

- Premium Perception Gap
- Physical Store Reliance
- Supply Chain Complexity
- Limited Presence in the US

O

- Circular Economy
- Digital Transformation
- Emerging Markets
- Eco-Design Focus

T

- Intense Competition
- Rise of C2C Platforms
- Economic Volatility
- Climate Change

RISKS / OPPORTUNITIES

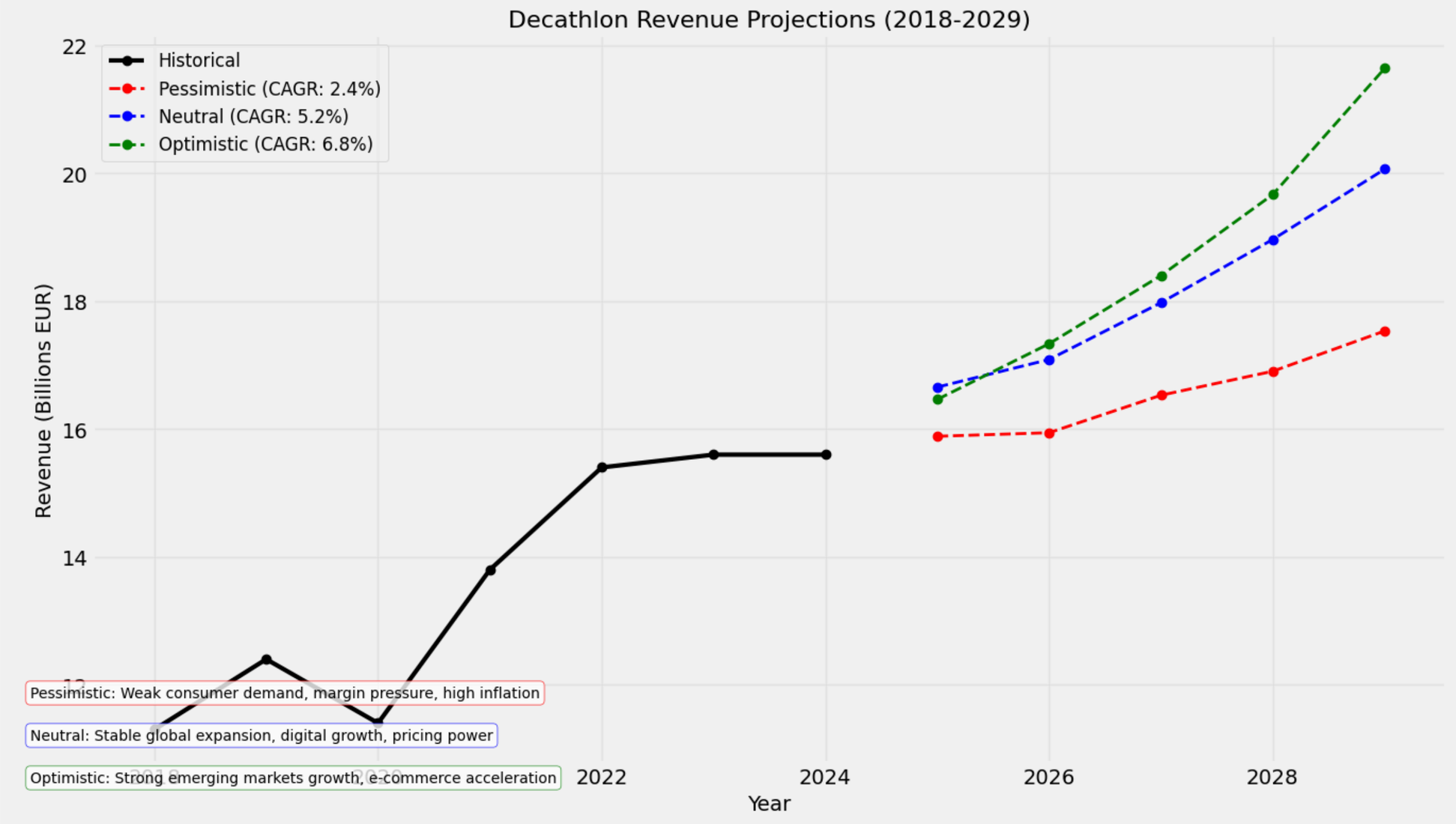
Strategic Opportunities

The Circular Revolution: Expanding "Decathlon Buyback" and rental subscription models to lead the sustainable transition and capture the growing second-hand market.
Digital Ecosystem & AI: Using Big Data and AI to provide hyper-personalized coaching (Decathlon Coach) and predictive inventory management to eliminate waste.
Premiumization Strategy: Scaling "Expert Brands" (e.g., Van Rysel for pro cycling, Kiprun for elite running) to compete directly with high-end specialist brands.
Emerging Market Dominance: Further penetration into India, SE Asia, and Latin America, where a growing middle class is increasing sports participation.

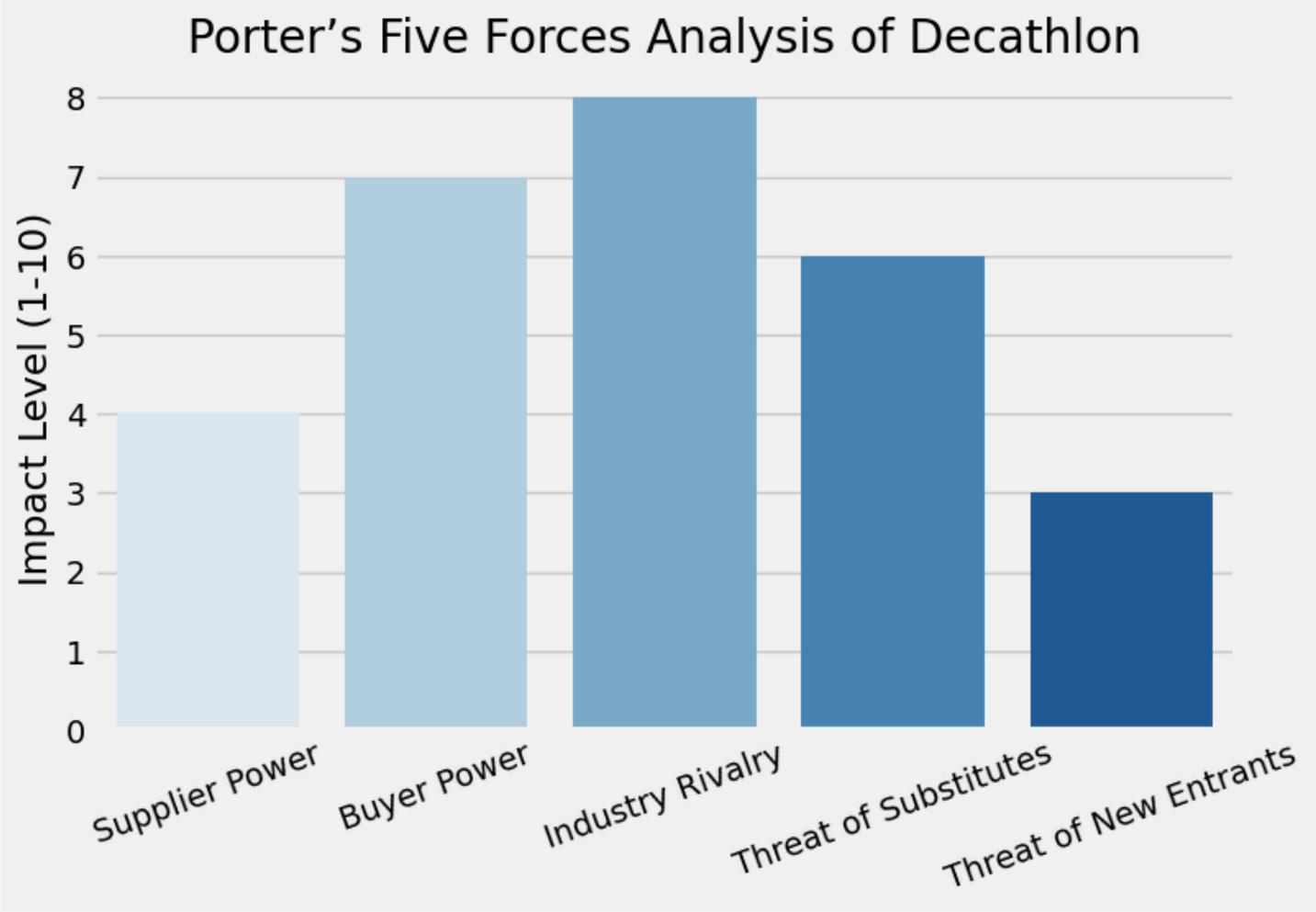
Critical Risks

Brand Perception Gap: The risk of remaining perceived only as a "value/budget" brand, making it difficult to gain loyalty from high-spending elite athletes.
Climate & Seasonality: Shortening winter seasons directly threaten the profitability of heavy-winter gear (skiing/snowboarding), a historically massive revenue driver.
Supply Chain Vulnerability: Heavy reliance on Asian manufacturing makes the company sensitive to geopolitical shifts, rising shipping costs, and labor regulations.

PROJECTION


Decathlon Revenue Projections (2018-2029)
Historical
Pessimistic (CAGR: 2.4%)
Neutral (CAGR: 5.2%)
Optimistic (CAGR: 6.8%)
Revenue (Billions EUR)
22
20
18
16
14
2022
2024
2026
2028
Year
Pessimistic: Weak consumer demand, margin pressure, high inflation
Neutral: Stable global expansion, digital growth, pricing power
Optimistic: Strong emerging markets growth, e-commerce acceleration

5 PORTER FORCES



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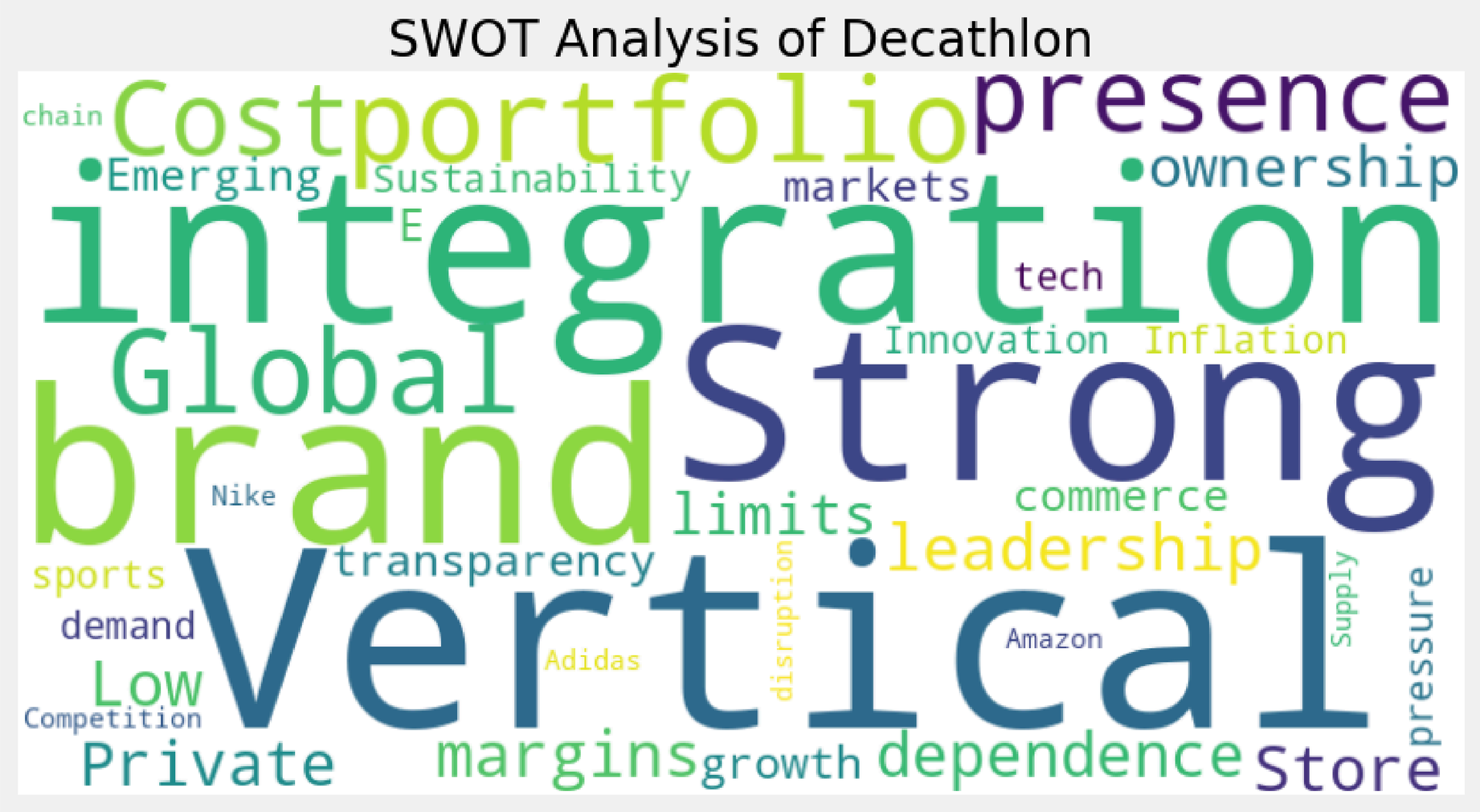
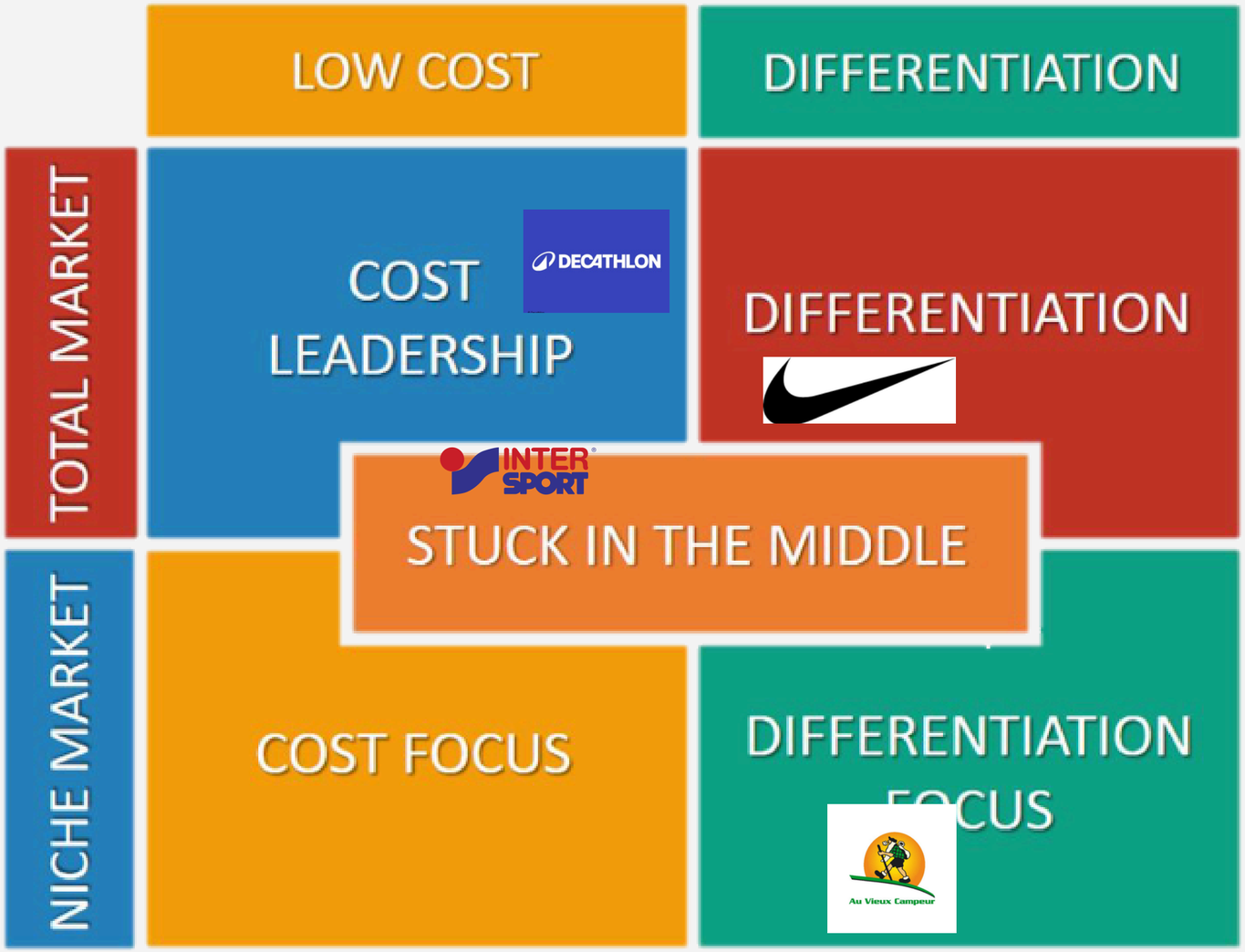

SWOT Analysis of Decathlon
chain
Costportfolio
presence
Emerging
Sustainability
markets
ownership
integration
E
tech
Innovation
Inflation
Global
Strong
brand
Nike
limits
commerce
leadership
sports
transparency
disruption
Supply
pressure
Vertical
demand
Amazon
Adidas
Low
Competition
Private
margins
growth
dependence
Store

POSITION OF DÉCATHLON



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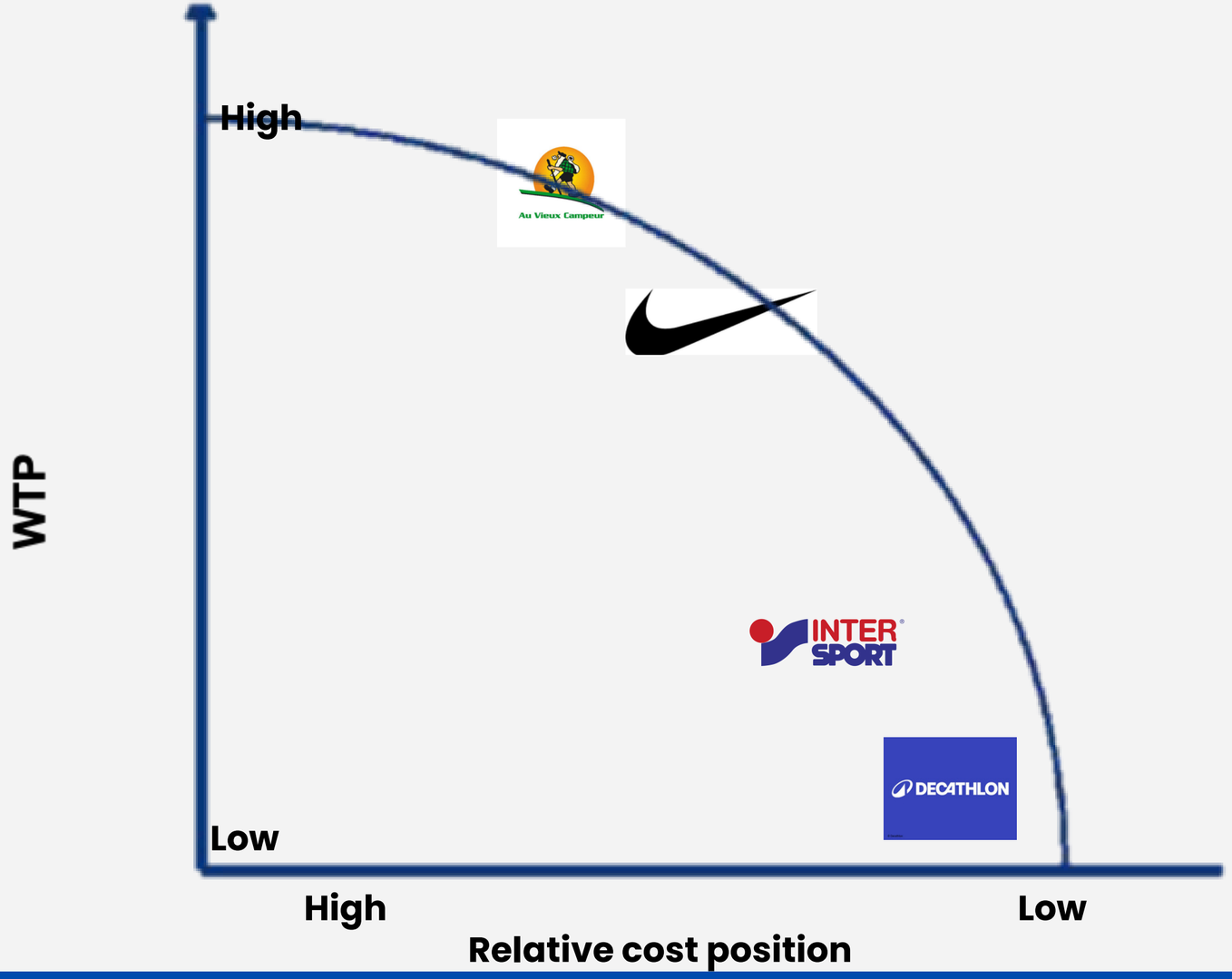


II - MICRO

PROBLEMATIC

How can Decathlon successfully integrate a 'High-Performance' brand strategy alongside its 'Mass-Market' identity without diluting its brand image?

Objective : Conquer new markets, potentially the American market and the high-performance sports sector

OPPORTUNITIES AND RISKS FOR THIS SOLUTION

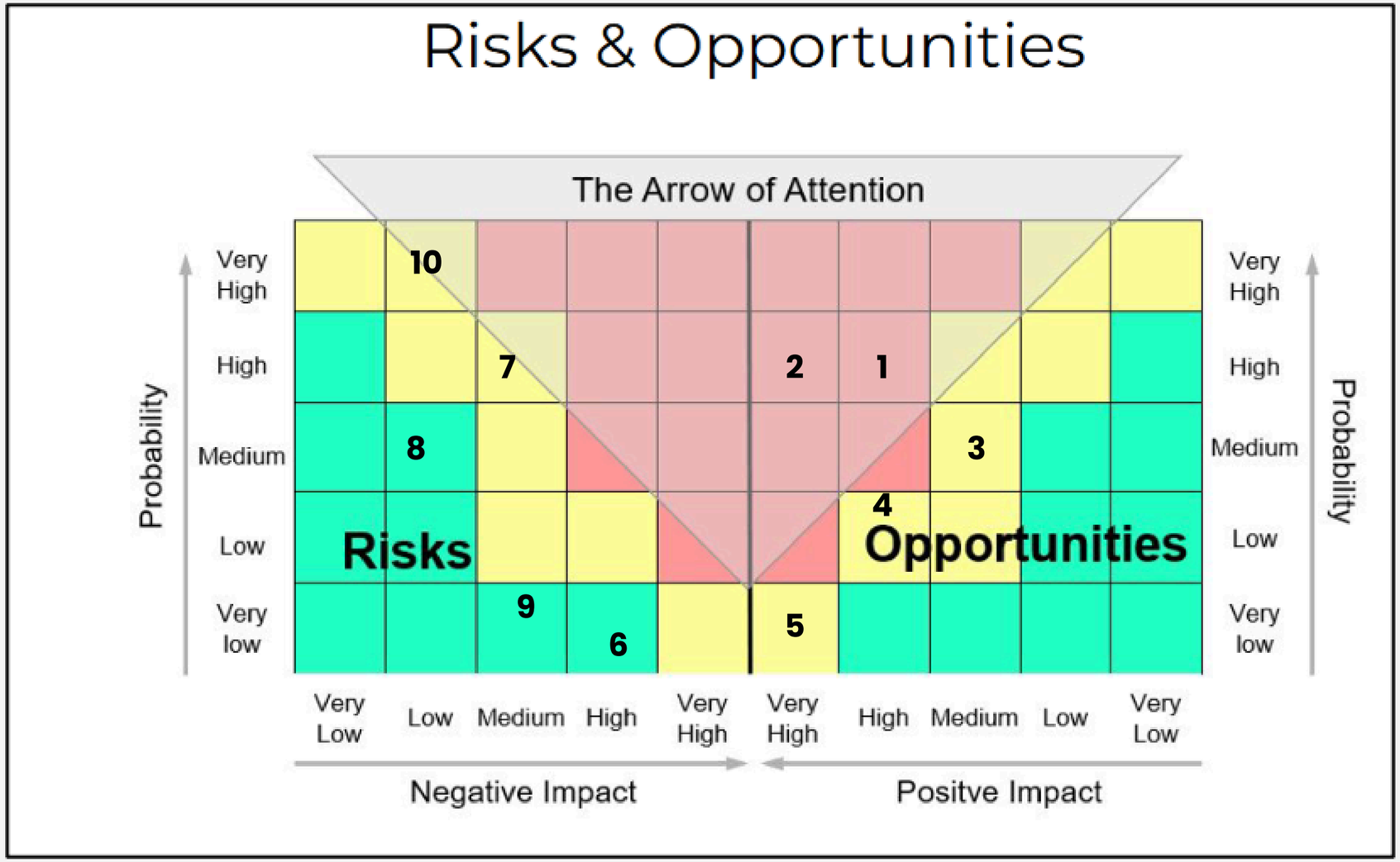
5 Key Opportunities (Benefits)

1. *The "Halo Effect": Professional prestige boosts overall brand trust.*
2. *Tech Trickle-Down: Elite innovation improves everyday gear.*
3. *Market Expansion: Capturing high-spending "Expert" athletes.*
4. *Higher Margins : Premium products drive better profitability.*
5. *Global Authority : From a French retailer to a world sports leader.*

5 Key Risks (Challenges)

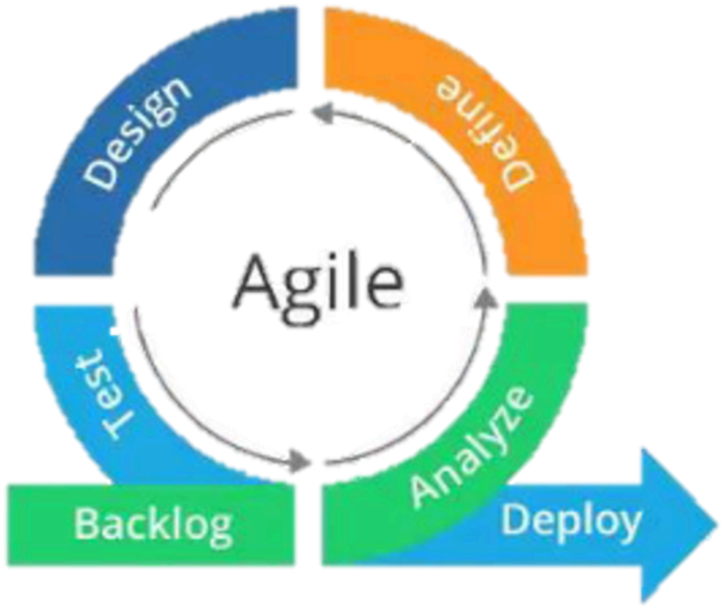
6.Brand Dilution: Risk of losing the "affordable" DNA.
7.Credibility Gap: Fighting elite brand snobbery (Nike/Specialized).
8.Resource Drain: Massive R&D and sponsorship costs.
9.Customer Confusion: Complex choices between "Basic" and "Pro" lines.
10.Retail Complexity: Need for highly specialized in-store staff.

NEGOTIATION

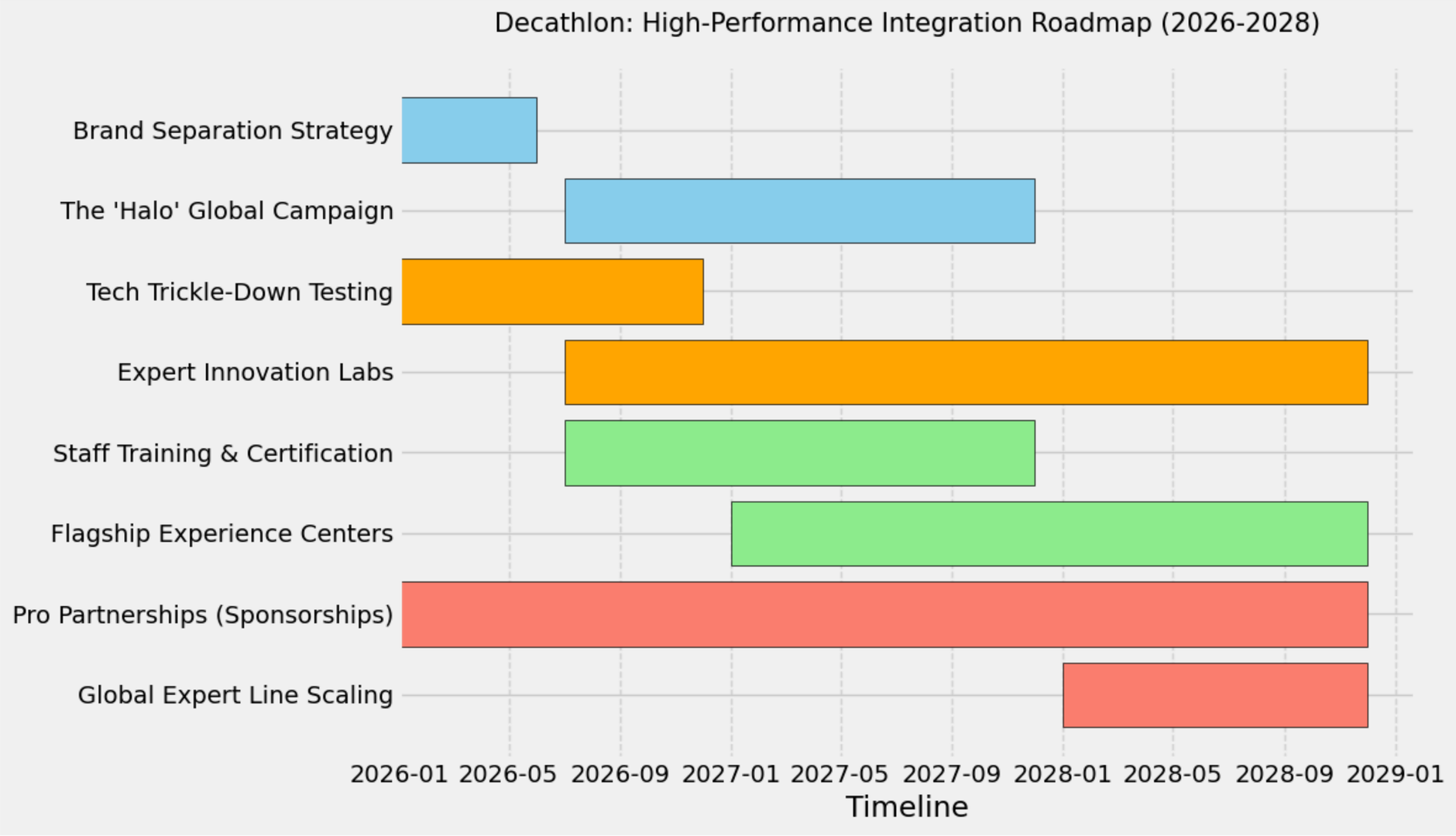


AGILE METHOD

Phase	Key Agile Actions
Product Backlog	Prioritizing high-tech features (Aerodynamics, Weight, Durability).
Sprints	Fast-track development of "Hero Products" (ex : the new Kiprun carbon shoe).
Sprint Review	Technical testing by pros + "Alpha" testing by loyal store customers.
Iterative Release	Launching "Limited Editions" for experts before mass-market rollout.



SCHEDULE


Decathlon: High-Performance Integration Roadmap (2026-2028)
Brand Separation Strategy
The 'Halo' Global Campaign
Tech Trickle-Down Testing
Expert Innovation Labs
Staff Training & Certification
Flagship Experience Centers
Pro Partnerships (Sponsorships)
Global Expert Line Scaling
2026-01
2026-05
2026-09
2027-01
2027-05
2027-09
2028-01
2028-05
2028-09
2029-01
Timeline

ROI

PHASE	INVESTMENT	INCREMENTAL REV.	NET PROFIT	CUMULATIVE ROI
Year 1 (Setup)	-€150M	€50M	-€40M	-26%
Year 2 (Scaling)	-€100M	€250M	€60M	13%
Year 3 (Maturity)	-€50M	€600M	€180M	130%

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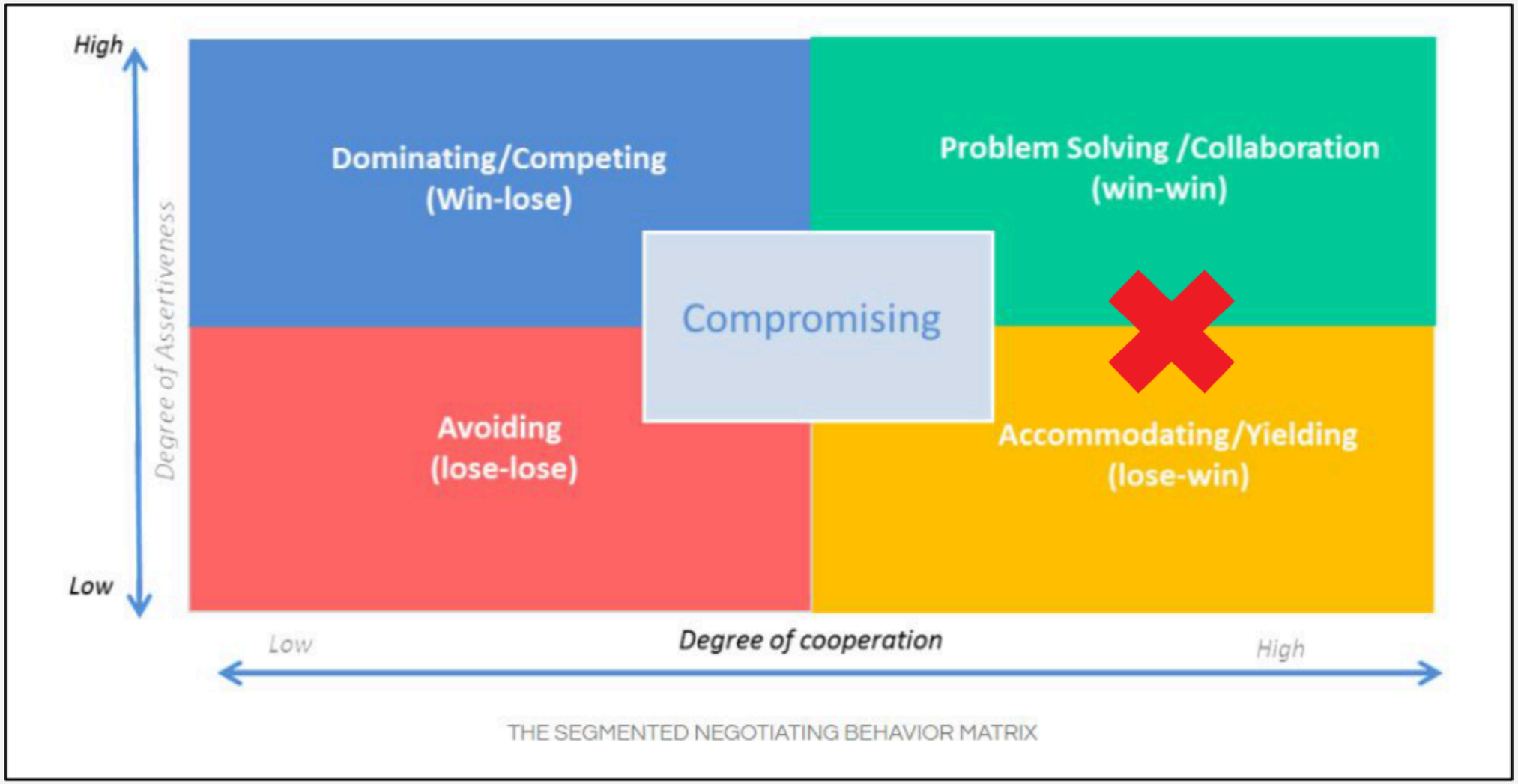
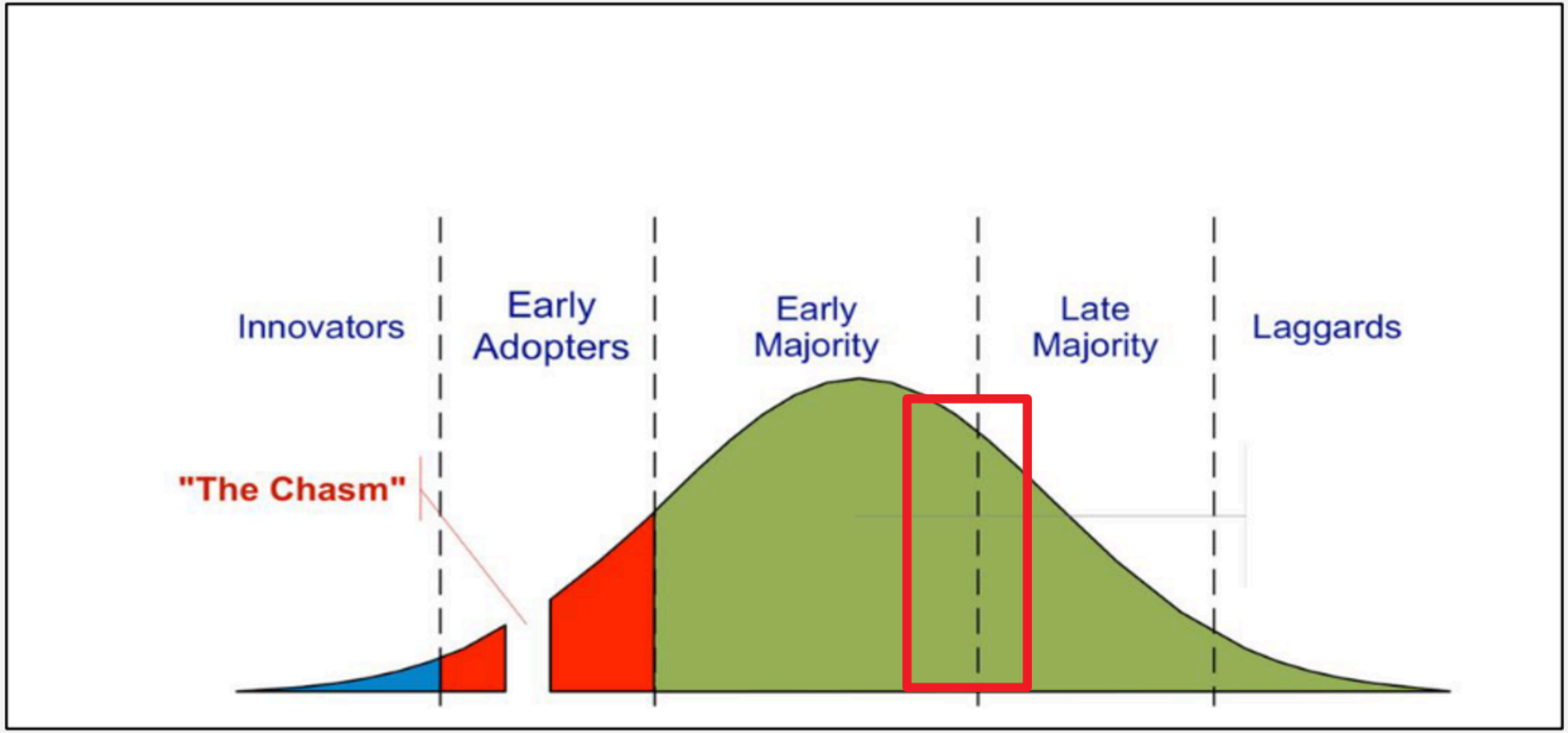


TECH IMPLEMENTATION CURVE



POSSIBLE EXTENSION

By leveraging AI-driven hyper-personalized customer experiences, Decathlon can evolve from a product-focused retailer into a true performance partner, delivering tailored expertise at scale across its expert brands